

WEEKLY BUSINESS SESSION –July 22, 2026

9:00m. – Anne Basker Auditorium
600 N.W. Sixth Street, Grants Pass, OR 97526

Present: Ron Smith, Chair-Commissioner; Colene Martin, Vice-Chair-Commissioner and Gary Richardson, Commissioner (Absent), Nikole Guzman, Recorder

These are meeting minutes only. Only text enclosed in quotation marks reports a speaker's exact words.

Pursuant to notice through the media and in conformance with the Public Meeting Law, Ron Smith, Chair, called the meeting to order at 9:00 a.m. followed by the Pledge of Allegiance.

Items discussed were as follows:

1. **CALL MEETING TO ORDER:** Pursuant to notice through the media and in conformance with the Public Meeting Law, Ron Smith, Chair, called the meeting to order at 9:00 a.m.
2. **CONVENING AS THE GOVERNING BODY OF THE JOSEPHINE COUNTY 4-H Extension/OSU SERVICE DISTRICT:** The Board temporarily recessed its capacity as the Josephine County Board of Commissioners and convened as the Governing Body of the Josephine County 4-H/Extension Service District.
 - a. **4-H Extension/OSU Service District IGA**

Wally Hicks, County Legal Counsel, presented the proposed Intergovernmental Agreement between the Josephine County 4-H/Extension Service District and Oregon State University Extension Service.

Mr. Hicks explained that the agreement has a five-year term ending June 30, 2031. The agreement establishes the responsibilities of the District and Oregon State University, including the District's provision of annual funding and operational support through the budget process and OSU's delivery of educational programs and information to Josephine County residents. The agreement also addresses the provision and funding of an appropriate facility for Extension programs and staff.

Legal Counsel noted that representatives of OSU had attended the July 14 County Administration Workshop and answered the Board's questions regarding facilities, funding, furnishings, travel expenses, and the administration of District funds. Mr. Hicks stated that he had no remaining concerns and recommended approval of the agreement. Commissioner Martin stated that her questions had also been resolved and thanked Legal Counsel for completing the additional review.

Commissioner Martin made a motion to approve the 4H Extension/OSU Service District IGA, seconded by Commissioner Smith. Upon roll call, Commissioner Richardson –absent, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – yes. Motion carried 2-0.

The Board concluded the meeting of the Governing Body of the Josephine County 4-H/Extension Service District and reconvened as the Josephine County Board of Commissioners.

3. **DECLARE A POTENTIAL CONFLICT OF INTEREST:** The commissioners reserved their right to declare a potential conflict of interest
4. **PROCLAMATION:**
 - a. In the Matter of Proclaiming the Week of July 19-25, 2026, as Probation, Parole and Community Supervision Week

Commissioner Smith read a proclamation recognizing the week of July 19 through July 25, 2026, as Probation, Parole and Community Supervision Week in Josephine County.

The proclamation recognized community justice professionals for upholding the law, safeguarding the public, supervising justice-involved individuals, supporting accountability and rehabilitation, and working in partnership with community agencies. It also recognized their work in prevention, intervention, advocacy, victim support, restorative justice, and the successful reintegration of individuals into the community.

Chair Smith thanked Community Justice employees for performing difficult and important work and for helping individuals make positive changes and return to productive participation in the community. Commissioner Martin

also expressed appreciation, noting that much of their work occurs behind the scenes and often does not receive the public recognition it deserves.

5. ADMINISTRATIVE ACTION(S) IN CONSIDERATION OF: None

6. REQUESTS/COMMENTS FROM CITIZENS: *(Each person will be given three (3) minutes to speak)*

Stephen Fitch, Josephine County, spoke regarding government accountability, constitutional rights, and his belief that public officials and employees had retaliated against him for exercising lawful speech and petitioning government.

Deb Berg Josephine County, thanked the Board for approving the 4-H/Extension Service District budget and expressed enthusiasm regarding the return and expansion of Extension programs.

BOARD MAY REVIEW PUBLIC COMMENTS/QUESTIONS:

7. APPROVAL OF CONSENT CALENDAR:

a. Minutes *(Draft minutes are available for viewing in the Board's Office)*

Addiction Mental and Public Health Advisory Committee – May 21, 2026

Admin Workshop – July 14, 2026

Weekly Business Session – July 15, 2026

Commissioner Martin made a motion to approve the Consent Calendar, seconded by Commissioner Smith. Upon roll call, Commissioner Richardson –absent, Commissioner Martin – yes, Commissioner Smith – yes. Motion carried 2-0.

8. OTHER: (ORS 192.640(1)) “... notice shall include a list of the principal subjects anticipated to be considered at the meeting, but this requirement shall not limit the ability of a governing body to consider additional subjects.”)

Commissioner Martin thanked the firefighters who responded to recent fires in the Cave Junction area. She stated that their rapid response prevented the fires from becoming substantially more serious and encouraged residents to thank firefighters for their service.

Commissioner Smith reported that he had received a final update regarding the East Evans Creek Fire indicating that crews had made substantial progress and were performing mop-up operations and extinguishing remaining hot spots. He commended the firefighters for their work in steep, rugged, and heavily vegetated terrain and urged the public to remain cautious because fire season was not over

9. ANNOUNCEMENTS: MATTERS FROM COMMISSIONERS:

Commissioner Martin announced that the Josephine County Fair would begin the following Wednesday and continue through Sunday. She encouraged residents to attend, bring their families, and participate in the community activities. She noted that the forecast anticipated somewhat cooler weather.

Chair Smith added that weather conditions also appeared favorable for a relatively smoke-free Fair week.

Weekly Business Session adjourned at 9:15 a.m.



Nikole Guzman, Recorder